

ICFAI Founders Network — User Guide

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Welcome to the ICFAI Founders Network

A private home for ICFAI founders. Bring an idea, validate it through a mentored pipeline, find teammates, learn from real failures, and stay connected to the community.

This guide walks you through everything you can do, screen by screen.

1. Getting started

YOUR ACCOUNT

- If you have an ICFAI email, register yourself at **/register**, open the confirmation link we email you, then sign in.
- If your account was set up for you, you'll receive an email with a temporary password. Sign in with it, then change it in **Settings**.
- Forgot your password? On the login screen choose **Forgot password** and follow the email.

SETTING UP YOUR PROFILE

The first time you sign in, you'll complete a short profile: your name, region, sector, and domain, plus an optional startup, phone, and LinkedIn. This takes a minute and unlocks the rest of the app. You can edit it anytime from **Profile** or **Settings**.

2. Finding your way around

- **Left rail** — your main navigation: Feed, Idea Pipeline, Problem Hub, Team Acquisition, Directory, and the Autopsy Library.
- **Top bar** — a calendar shortcut, the **bell** for notifications, and your **profile menu** (Profile, Settings, Log out).
- **The bell** — shows recent notifications and upcoming events at a glance. Choose **Expand notifications** to open the full list.

3. The Feed

The community wall.

- Share an update, **create a poll**, or raise a **problem** for others to weigh in on.
- **Vote** and **comment** on what others post.
- Pinned posts sit at the top so you never miss an announcement.

If posting is paused for an event or review window, you'll see it temporarily disabled — it always comes back.

4. The Idea Pipeline

This is the heart of the network: a guided path that takes your idea from first submission to incubation. Every idea you submit gets its own **IFN-#** reference.

THE SIX GATES

Gate	Stage	What's happening
G1	Idea Submitted	Your application is in the review queue.
G2	Mentor Assigned	A reviewer has been assigned and is about to pick it up.
G3	Picked Up	Time to complete your full dossier — details and supporting files.
G4	Review Completed	Your dossier passed the rubric. Submit your beta plan.
G5	Beta Prototyping	Build. To advance, show evidence: a prototype link or files.
G6	Incubation	Confirmed. Work continues through actions and the idea's thread.

KNOWING WHOSE TURN IT IS

Each idea shows a status chip so you always know what's next:

- **Your move** — something is waiting on you.
- **With reviewer / In the queue** — it's being looked at.
- **Needs admin** — an administrator has to act.
- **Done** — no action pending.

WHAT REVIEWERS LOOK AT

Your idea is scored on a clear rubric: **clarity, feasibility, market potential, innovation, technical strength, scalability, and problem–solution fit**. Use these as a checklist while you prepare.

OUTCOMES

An idea can stay **Active**, be sent back to **Refine & retry** (improve and resubmit), or be **Rejected**. Refine is an invitation, not a no.

FUNDING

At the **Beta Prototyping** stage you may be able to flag your idea for incubation funding, when that option is open. Keep your evidence ready.

Tip: Keep the idea's thread updated. A well-documented dossier moves faster than a thin one.

5. Problem Hub

A place for real, unsolved problems worth building around.

- Post a problem you've seen or lived.
- Others reply in an open thread with approaches and solutions.

Browse it before you build — the best ideas start from a validated problem.

6. Team Acquisition

Hiring for your startup? Post a role. Want to join one? Apply.

- **Post a role need:** the title, who you're looking for, the commitment, your stage, and the skills required.
 - **Apply to others:** send a short message and the contact details you're comfortable sharing. Your account email stays private.
 - Posters review applicants and can open or close a role anytime.
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7. Directory

A searchable list of everyone in the network. Filter by role, sector, or region to find the right person, then open their profile to see their startup, links, and how to reach them.

8. Autopsy Library

Honest post-mortems of ideas and startups that didn't make it — what went wrong, and the lessons that outlived them.

- Browse by category to learn from others' missteps.
 - Share your own with **Share Your Autopsy**. Submissions are reviewed before they're published, so the library stays high-signal.
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9. Calendar and Notifications

- **Calendar** — upcoming sessions, deadlines, and events. A quick view also lives in the bell's *Upcoming Events*.
 - **Notifications** — updates on your posts, your applications, and your pipeline activity. The bell shows a badge when you have unread items; **Expand notifications** opens the full history.
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10. Settings and your account

From **Settings** you can:

- Update your profile details.
 - Change your password.
 - Set your notification preferences.
 - Sign out of every device at once.
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11. If something looks off

- **"Account suspended" or read-only:** an administrator has restricted the account. Reach out to the IFN team if you think it's a mistake.
 - **Can't post:** posting may be temporarily paused.
 - **Trouble signing in:** use **Forgot password**. After several quick attempts you'll get a short cooldown — wait it out and try again.
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Welcome aboard. Build something worth talking about.